

The Oasis

THE OASIS

A colony survival framework.



A colony ship carrying 5,000 sleeping settlers woke 400 years crushing into the world they left, which had died while they slept. Now 4,400 survivors live in a crashed ship on the edge of a post apocalyptic world, surrounded by ruins and terror.

THE SETTING

*Cold first. Then amber light..
Emergency..*

*A face. Kebolt Hemington, Crew
Welfare. He's supposed to be the
first thing you see when you
arrive.*

*"Something went wrong with the
drive.*

*"Its... its gone. The Korenfeld
Drive is gone."*

*"We're back in Rimaer. 400 years
have passed. The world is ruined.
The ship came down hard, we
crushed back into the planet." A
pause. "Life support can't hold
everyone. Most of the colony's still
under."*

*He meets your eyes. "We're
waking people when we need
them."
"We need you."*



THE WORLD YOU LEFT

Rimaer-Prime was human civilization at its apex. Sixty two billion people.

One government — the **Pantheon**, spanning a single temperate world and three terraformed moons. Disease eliminated. Lifespans extended. Cybernetics common. A Dyson sphere under construction around the sun.

The **Korenfeld Drive** — humanity's first FTL engine, proven and ready for its first true test.

The Pantheon's plan was vast. One hundred colony ships, five thousand colonists each, sent to one hundred worlds within two hundred light-years. You were one of the five thousand aboard **The Oasis**, the first ship to launch. The test. The flagship. The one the whole civilization was watching.

WHAT HAPPENED

Something went wrong with the Korenfeld Drive.

The Oasis's records show only this: the main drive failed partway through its rewrite process. The smaller backup drive engaged automatically and spent approximately **400 years** completing

an emergency trace-back. When the ship came out of the **Medium**, it was above Rimaer Prime, the world it had left. The instruments confirmed the date. Four centuries had passed.

The communications array found no Pantheon transmissions. No civilian broadcasts. No emergency signals on any frequency the Oasis was built to receive. The orbit was decaying. By the time you woke the ship already crushed back into the planet.

_____ TONE

Tragic science fiction. A colony of the last survivors of human civilization trying to stay alive on the ruins of everything they came from.

There is no villain to defeat. No justice to extract. Only 4,400 people who need to eat, stay warm, and figure out what happened to the world they left. And maybe, just maybe, rebuild the drive that got them here.

This framework is for players who want to care about the people around them, not just the mission. Sessions are about hard calls with no clean answers: who gets woken next, what gets rationed, which expedition is worth the risk. Characters come with histories. Those histories matter. The person in the next bunk is not a side character.

The horror is slow. It lives in what the world has become and in what people become under pressure. You will not defeat something and feel safe again. Safety is not the destination.

The Storyteller's job is not to punish the players. It is to make the stakes feel real.

_____ INSPIRED BY

Fiction: The Thing, Annihilation, Children of time.

Video Games: Rimworld, Subnautica.

TTRPGs: Mothership.

_____ WHAT YOU WOKE TO

The Oasis is down. It came down in a marshland at the edge of what was once a coastal metropolitan region. Most of the hull is intact. Enough of it isn't.

Life support is rationed — the ship cannot sustain 4,400 people simultaneously on its current reserves. Most colonists are still in cryosleep. People are being woken in shifts, as the colony needs them. You were woken because you were needed.

The world outside is not the Rimaer-Prime anyone aboard remembers.

- The cities are ruins, overgrown, scavenged, or still burning
- The land near the crash is anomalous in measurable ways
- There are people on the surface, survivors and their descendants
- Food and water are finite
- Power systems are degrading
- The anomalous marsh surrounds the crash site
- Surface factions are watching
- Political fractures are forming inside the colony
- Six hundred empty cryopods



TERMS & ASSUMPTIONS

KEY TERMS

The Medium — the fourth-dimensional substrate the Korenfeld Drive uses to fold space. Ships exist outside normal spacetime during transit. Duration inside the Medium does not map to duration outside it.

The Rewrite — the process of translating matter through the Medium and back. The main drive failed mid-rewrite. What that means for the ship, the colonists, and the world is still being studied.

Cryosleep — the hibernation state all 5,000 colonists were in during transit. Life support cannot sustain the full population awake simultaneously. Most are still under.

The Pantheon — the unified government of Rimaer-Prime before the collapse. Its records, laws, and scientific archive survived aboard the Oasis. The civilization itself did not.

Rimaer-Prime — the origin world. A single temperate planet that once held 62 billion people, three terraformed moons, and a Dyson sphere under construction. It collapsed while the Oasis was in the Medium. What is left is four centuries of ruins, survivors, and consequences.

The Korenfeld Drive — humanity's first faster-than-light engine, powered by the Dyson sphere under construction around Rimaer's sun. It works in two phases. First, the drive rewrites every atom of the ship and its contents into a Medium-compatible state — a process that takes days and requires enormous energy. Then the ship folds through the Medium and emerges at the destination. The transit itself is instantaneous. The rewrite is not.

The Oasis carried a main drive and a smaller backup. The main drive failed mid-rewrite and is gone. The backup completed a 400-year emergency trace-back and burned out on arrival. The knowledge to rebuild one exists in the Pantheon archive. Whether the energy and materials to do so exist on Rimaer-Prime is what the Astrogator is trying to determine.

The Directorate — the colony's governing council. Nine roles, each responsible for a critical domain: logistics, security, medicine, research,

engineering, community, navigation, and the Prime Prefect who holds legal authority over all of them.

The Remnants — the people on the surface. Survivors and their descendants, living in the ruins of Rimaer-Prime for four hundred years without a central government. Organized into settlements, factions, and cults. Not all of them are hostile. Probably...

Anomalous Zones — area site where physical measurements behave incorrectly. Instruments give inconsistent readings. Objects and organisms that enter do not always return unchanged.

IDEAS & ASSUMPTIONS

The ship is the colony. Until it is repaired, reinforced, or replaced, the Oasis is civilization. Leaving it without a plan is not heroism. It is subtraction from a finite resource.

Technology works. The Pantheon archive is intact. Fabricators are running. Medicine is functional at reduced capacity. This is not a primitive survival story — it is a resource management story with advanced tools that are slowly running out.

You want to survive, or get off the planet. The Oasis is not a ship. It is a colony. It is a home. It is a way to rebuild the drive that got you here. It is not a shipwreck. It is not a dead world. It is not a prison. It is not a graveyard. It is a home.

The surface is hostile. People live out there. They have for four centuries. The players can go outside, trade, fight, explore. The anomalous zones are the hard boundary, not the surface itself.

No one knows what happened. The drive failed. That is all the records say. Players and Storyteller should treat the cause as an open question until the story reveals it.

THE COLONY

The Oasis is the colony. Until it is repaired, reinforced, or abandoned, every system aboard is a survival question. The ship's reactors are holding. The fabricators can produce most essential equipment. The armory is intact. The Pantheon archive has every scientific record.

WHAT YOU HAVE

- 4,400 colonists, specialists in everything
- Fabricators (partially damaged)
- Seed banks and hydroponic bays (damaged)
- Full Pantheon scientific and cultural archive
- Medical facility at reduced capacity
- Armory and trained marines
- Backup Korenfeld Drive, inert, not operational

WHAT YOU DON'T HAVE

- A way off the planet
- Contact with the Pantheon
- Allies on the surface
- Answers

THE DRIVE

The backup drive is inert — it completed its 400-year emergency trace-back and burned out. The Pantheon physics archive is intact. The knowledge to rebuild a Korenfeld Drive may exist in those records. Whether the materials, the energy, and the time to do so exist on Rimaer-Prime is a different question. The Astrogator is working on it.

THE DIRECTORATE

The Oasis was built to govern a peaceful colony on a friendly world. It is now governing a crash survival operation on a hostile post-apocalyptic one.

ROLE	RESPONSIBILITY
Prime Prefect	Colony authority
Chief of Logistics	Food, energy, resources; second in command
Chief Security	Marines and internal security
Biometric Director	Medicine, surgery, and genetics
Archive Director	Research, science, and databases
Core Director	Engineering and construction
Community Director	Morale, psychology, and culture
Astrogator	Korenfeld physics; rebuilding the drive



THE SURFACE

Four hundred years is enough time for a civilization to collapse, leave ruins, and have something else grow in the gap. What grew in the gap on Rimaer-Prime is still being mapped. What it means for the Oasis is still being determined.

THE MARSH

The crash site sits at the edge of a vast marshland that did not exist on any maps the Oasis carried. Something created it over the past four centuries — broken infrastructure, altered hydrology, and anomalous zones centered around certain sites across the planet.

The marsh is not uniformly dangerous. Large sections can be traversed with care. Others cannot — not because of anything visible, but because things that enter them do not reliably come back, or come back wrong.

ANOMALOUS ZONES

Scattered through the marsh and into the ruins are regions where matter behaves outside normal parameters. Your scientists can measure the effects. The measurements don't yet explain them.

The zones are not random. They cluster around certain sites — old places, geographically significant locations. The surface survivors treat these sites with reverence, fear, or both. The Oasis archive has no record of what those sites were before the collapse.

WHAT THE ZONES DO

Matter composition shifts under prolonged exposure. Cellular tissue transforms in patterns that don't match any known disease or mutation process. Objects placed in certain zones are recovered in altered states. The alterations have internal structure. That structure does not match any known physical process.



SURFACE FACTIONS

The world below is not empty. Four centuries of collapse, war, and survival have produced a layered surface politics the Oasis is only beginning to map. None of it was in the mission brief. None of it is simple.

THE TRADERS

Several groups have made contact and offered trade. They bring food, salvage, and local knowledge. They want medicine, fabricated tools, and anything from the ship's power systems. They are cautious but not hostile. Some speak fragments of old Pantheon Standard — enough to negotiate, not enough to explain. That level of linguistic preservation suggests institutional continuity somewhere in their history.

THE HOSTILE

At least two scouting parties have been attacked. The attackers used pre-collapse military salvage — recognizable by design, degraded by time. They do not pursue past certain boundaries, which suggests territorial logic rather than ideology. They have not attempted communication. The Directorate has not yet determined whether contact is possible or advisable.

THE WATCHERS

A third group observes the crash site from a consistent perimeter. They do not trade. They do not attack. They maintain distance and change positions between surveys. They have been there since the ship came down. What they are waiting for is not yet known.

THE CULT OF THE FOURTH

Active across several surface regions, the Cult of the Fourth treat the anomalous zones as sacred sites. Their rituals are centered on zone perimeters. They do not enter the zones. They mark them, maintain them, and drive others away from them. They have not made formal contact with the Oasis, but individual cult members have been encountered on the surface. They are aware of the ship. They appear to have been expecting it.

THE INTERESTED

At least one group has communicated a specific interest in something aboard the Oasis. What that something is has not been made clear. The communication was not hostile. It was precise. The Directorate is treating it as a priority intelligence matter.

WHAT YOU DON'T KNOW

The Oasis archive carries four hundred years of Pantheon history. The people on the surface carried the same history in their heads, filtered through four centuries of war, loss, and myth. The archive and the living memory do not agree on what happened.

The truth of the collapse is recoverable. It is buried in ruins, survivor accounts, and the ship's own records. Recovering it will take time, risk, and people willing to ask questions that may not have good answers.

ON DISCOVERY

The history of the collapse is not one team's mission. It arrives in fragments, out of order, from sources with reasons to lie. Some answers will be wrong. Some will be right in ways that make the others worse.

Character Creation

CHARACTER CREATION

You are an Oasis colonist who just woke from cryosleep. You had a career, a role, and a life on Rimaer-Prime before you boarded. All of that is 400 years gone — but it shaped who you are, what you can do, and what is already cracked inside you waiting to open under pressure.

- 1 Choose **2 Proficiencies** from the crew manifest — the careers and competencies that define what you are trained to do.
Choose **2 Specialties** — one narrow focus under each Proficiency. Each contributes +2 when it clearly applies.
- 2 Choose **2 Traits** — permanent personality features that define how you act under pressure. They can become Burdens when the fiction demands it.
- 3 Receive your **Pantheon Standard Kit**.
- 4 Assume any tools appropriate to your proficiencies are in your personal kit.
Define **1 relationship** with another colonist — someone you knew before cryo, or someone you have connected with since waking. Name them. Say what it is.
- 5 Choose **1 Play** — a narrative tool that gives you permission to do something creative, dramatic, or unexpected.
- 6

IF YOU'D HAVE IT

Colonists don't inventory every item. If something fits your proficiency and your life aboard the Oasis, you have it. If it's rare, dangerous, or colony-critical — ask the Storyteller.

OPENING QUESTIONS

Answer these together before play begins. They are not backstory — they are the beginning of the story.

AS A GROUP

Which of you knew each other before boarding?

What were you doing on Rimaer-Prime in the weeks before launch?

What was the first thing each of you saw when your pod opened?

Which of the 600 empty pods did you walk past first?

PANTHEON STANDARD KIT

Every colonist receives:

SEALED WORK COVERALL

PERSONAL TABLET (PANTHEON DATABASE ACCESS)

STANDARD RATION PACK (3 DAYS)

WATER CANTEEN AND FLASHLIGHT

PANTHEON ID AND SUBDERMAL COMM IMPLANT

Proficiencies

PROFICIENCIES

Choose 2 **proficiencies** from the crew manifest below. These are the roles you held aboard the Oasis — what you trained for, what you were hired for, what you know. You may create your own with Storyteller approval.

ENGINEERING & MAINTENANCE

- ZERO-G SHIPBREAKER
- HEAVY MACHINERY OPERATOR
- STRUCTURAL ENGINEER
- REACTOR / POWER SYSTEMS TECH
- CYBERNETICS TECHNICIAN
- SANITATION / RECYCLER

SCIENCE & RESEARCH

- PLANETOLOGIST
- XENOBIOLOGIST / PATHOLOGIST
- HYDROPONICS AGRONOMIST
- ASTROGATOR / DRIVE SPECIALIST
- DEEP-SPACE ARCHAEOLOGIST
- SOPHONTOLOGIST

MEDICAL & SUPPORT

- TRAUMA SURGEON
- PHARMACOLOGIST / CHEMIST
- CRYO-STASIS TECHNICIAN
- COLONY PSYCHOLOGIST
- RATION QUARTERMASTER / COOK
- GENETICIST

SECURITY & TACTICAL

- PANTHEON MARINE
- CLOSE-QUARTERS BREACHER
- BRIG WARDEN / CORRECTIONS OFFICER
- ARTILLERY / EXPLOSIVES TECH
- INTERNAL SECURITY OPERATIVE

ADMINISTRATION

- PANTHEON MAGISTRATE / DIPLOMAT
- IDEOLOGUE / MORAL GUIDE
- OASIS ARCHIVIST
- COLONY ENTERTAINER
- PROPAGANDIST

SPECIALTY EXAMPLES

PROFICIENCY	SPECIALTY
Trauma Surgeon	Field amputation
Structural Engineer	Crash damage assessment
Pantheon Marine	Hostile terrain patrol
Planetologist	Anomalous zone reading
Colony Psychologist	Post-trauma stabilization
Oasis Archivist	Pre-collapse history

Plays

PLAYS

Choose **1 Play** at character creation. Plays are not bonuses — they are **permissions** to do something creative, dramatic, or unexpected. Per-scene plays reset each scene. Per-session plays reset each session.

PER-SCENE

READ BETWEEN THE LINES

Study a person, document, or scene. Ask the Storyteller one honest question.

Navigate an anomalous area without triggering exposure. You can't explain how you knew the path. You just did.

GHOST MOVE

Retroactively declare you moved to a different position before the current moment.

DESPERATE IMPROVISATION

Solve a problem using only what's in the scene. If the table finds it genuinely creative, it works — but the Storyteller names the cost.

JURY-RIG THE SCENE

Establish one detail about the current location that hasn't been mentioned yet.

MAKE A SCENE

Draw every eye to yourself for one beat. You choose what happens in that window.

BRACE FOR IMPACT

Danger hits, but you choose how it lands — and you're still standing.

ECHO

When someone else fails, turn their bad moment into your opening.

CONFESSIONAL

Reveal something true and hidden. Vulnerability becomes leverage.

WALK THE ZONE

PER-SESSION

I KNOW A GUY

Declare you know someone relevant. Describe the connection. They exist now.

INVOKE THE PAST

Introduce a fact, preparation, or connection from before cryo. The fiction adjusts.

PLAN B

When a plan falls apart, reveal the backup you prepared — but the Storyteller says what's missing.

SACRIFICE PLAY

Destroy or give up something that matters to guarantee one specific outcome.

DEAD MAN'S GAMBIT

Do something reckless and unexpected. If it's genuinely creative, complications don't apply.

COLONY FIRST

Endanger yourself to protect a critical colony resource, person, or system. If you survive, the colony gains something because of it.

FROM THE ARCHIVE

Cite specific Pantheon knowledge from the ship's database. It directly changes how a situation can be approached.

Traits

TRAITS

TRAITS (CHOOSE 2)

Traits define how your character acts under pressure. They are permanent personality anchors — and can become the basis for a Burden when the fiction demands it.

PSYCHOLOGICAL	PHYSICAL	SOCIAL
Volatile	Wimp	Abrasive
Pessimist	Trigger-Happy	Stubborn
Optimist	Careful Shooter	Kind
Neurotic	Brawler	Loud
Hyper-Empathetic	Sickly	Creepy Presence
Claustrophobic	Klutz	Absent-Minded

TRAITS UNDER PRESSURE

Traits are not background details. They are active — they define the choices a character makes when the stakes are real.

A Trait becomes a **Burden** when a situation directly targets it and the fiction demands a real cost. A **Volatile** character who holds it together demonstrates strength. One who doesn't — who snaps, escalates, puts someone in danger — generates a Narrative Point for the table.

TRAITS AS INVITATION

The most useful Traits are not the ones that never come up — they are the ones that surface at the worst possible moment and cost something real.

RUNNING THE OASIS

The Oasis is survival science fiction with a horror edge. The horror is not supernatural — it is consequential. The world didn't break because of monsters. It broke because of people, and their choices, and an aftermath that outlives every choice made.

Your colonists are not heroes arriving to fix things. They are survivors trying to build something survivable in a world still paying for something they weren't there to witness.

WHAT PLAYERS KNOW AT SESSION ONE

The drive failed. The world collapsed while they slept. The surface is wrong in measurable ways. There are people out there who know things the colonists don't. Something is broadcasting from the marsh.

WHAT THEY WILL DISCOVER

Why the world ended. What the anomalies are. Where the broadcast comes from and what it has been saying for four hundred years. Whether the drive can be rebuilt. Whether the colony still wants to leave once it understands why it came back.

The colony is a pressure system: food, power, morale, and security all degrade without maintenance. Let the players feel that weight every session.

The surface is an antagonist. Not a monster. Not a faction. The marsh grinds without intent. Sessions without encounters — just the marsh, the wrong sound, the missing team member, the thing that came back different — are sessions doing their job.

Reward investigation with information that hurts. The truth of this world is recoverable. It does not help.